ONE LABEL. EVERY CARD.

This is the spec for rebuilding the HGA slab label so one layout carries sports, TCG and non-sport cards. The artwork is the current label. What changes is where the information sits, the weight of the box outlines, and a QR code on the back.

What changed from the current label

- **Front text is three fixed lines:** Subject, Version, Release. The slash-separated string is gone.
- **Serial and card number are right-aligned** on lines 2 and 3, under the cert.
- **Team no longer prints.** The serial moves off the logo row.
- **Box outlines are 0.5 pt** (were 0.25 pt): Auto Grade, Card Grade and the four subgrade boxes.
- **Back:** Cert Number replaces Card Number, and a QR code sits bottom right.
- **Unchanged:** label size, red field, pattern, holographic border, logo, box positions and sizes, grade and cert type, hologram.

In this package

FILE	USE
HGA-Label-Design-Spec.pdf	This document.
HGA-Label-Template.pdf	True size, vector, 3 pages: front with Auto Grade, front without, back. Opens in Illustrator. Placeholder text sits at the final positions and sizes.
backgrounds/	The same three layouts with no variable text, for whoever sets up the print template.

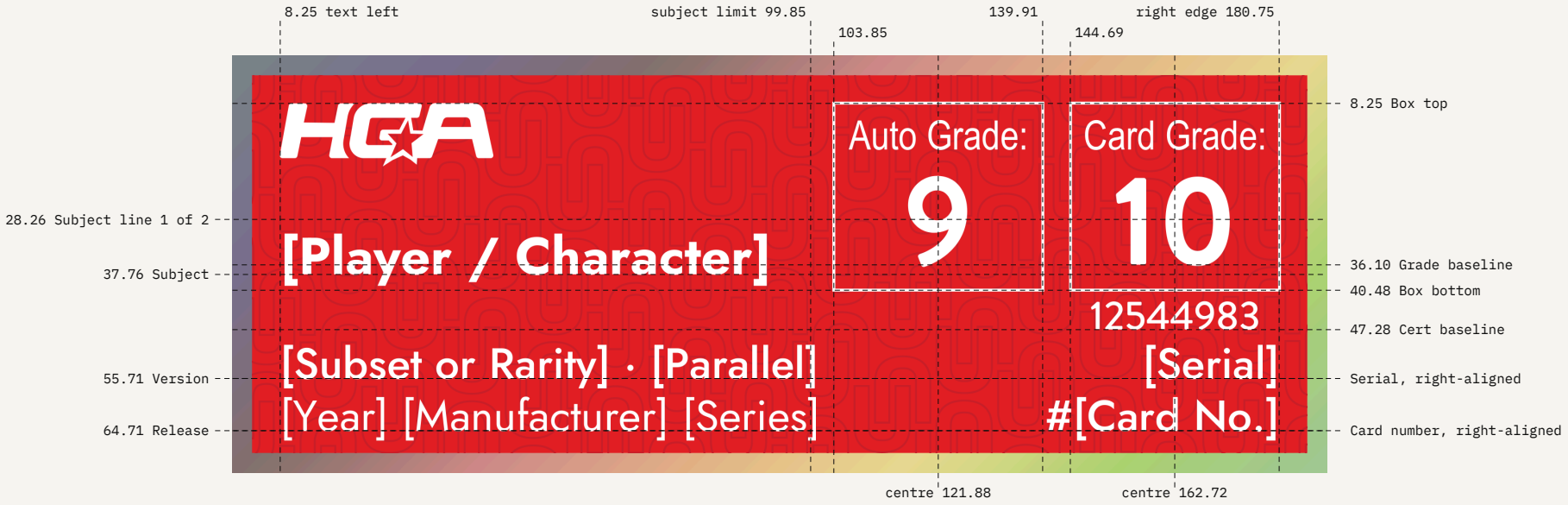
To rebuild in the source file

1. Open HGA-Label-Template.pdf beside the current Illustrator file.
2. Set the box strokes to 0.5 pt. Move nothing.
3. Replace the front text with the three lines at the positions on pages 2 and 3.
4. On the back, swap the Card Number line for Cert Number and place the QR square (page 4).
5. Swap the stand-in type for Brandon Grotesque at the sizes on page 5, then check the examples on pages 6 and 7.

Stand-in type: the new placeholder text in the template is set in Jost (for Brandon Grotesque) and Archivo Narrow (for Arial Narrow), because the licensed fonts were not available when this was built. Grades, cert and the original box labels are still the real fonts from the source file. Positions and sizes are final; only the typeface needs swapping.

Front positions

Points from the top-left corner of the 189 × 72 pt label. Text is placed by its baseline. Dashed lines are guides, not artwork.



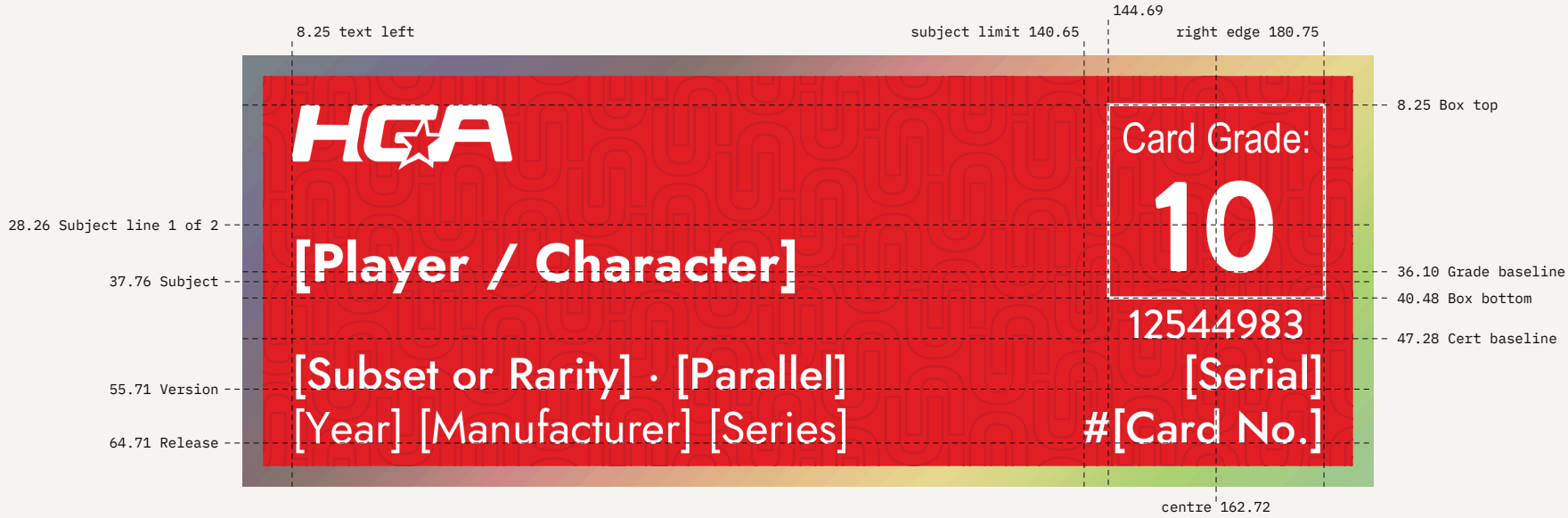
Subject. One line sits on 37.76. A name wider than 91.6 pt wraps, and the first line goes above on 28.26. Never more than two lines, never abbreviated.

Lines 2 and 3. Left-aligned at 8.25. The serial and card number are right-aligned at 180.75. Keep 8 pt clear between the text and the number.

Grades and cert. Same type and position as today. Grade numerals centre in their boxes; the cert centres under Card Grade.

Front without the Auto Grade box

When no autograph is graded, the Auto Grade box and its label are removed. Nothing else moves. The subject gains the width.



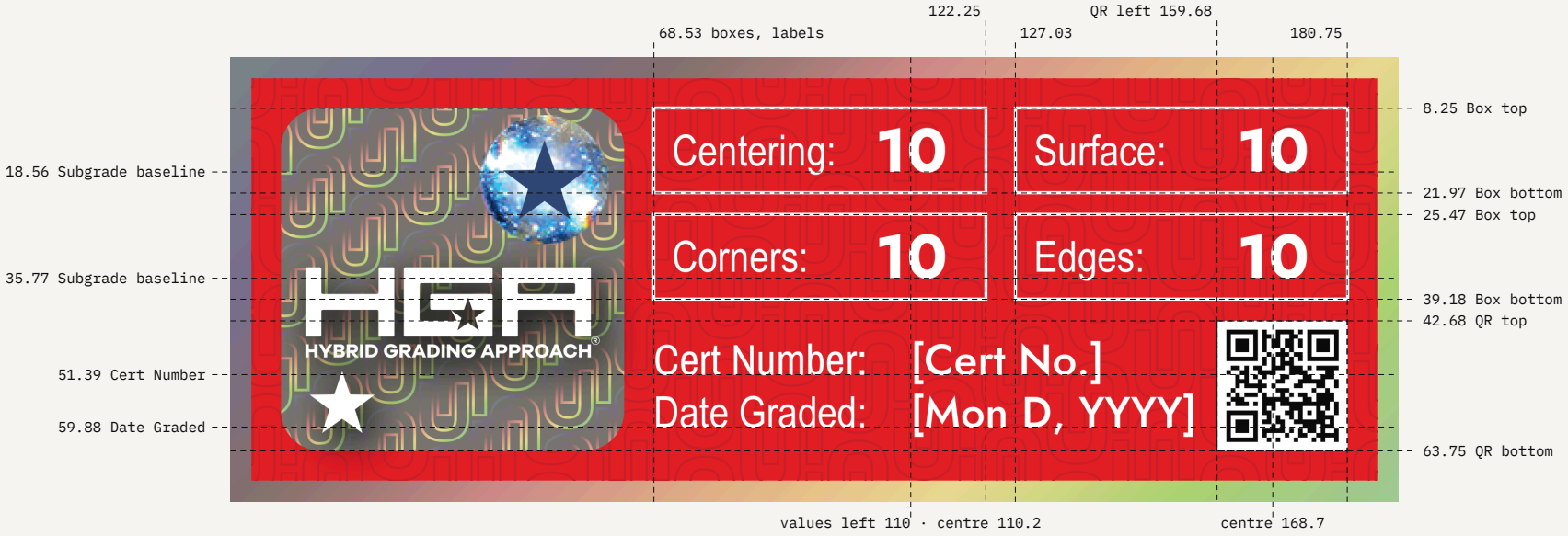
Subject width. 132.4 pt beside one box, 91.6 pt beside two. About 28 and 19 characters in Brandon Grotesque Bold 9 pt.

Line capacity. Lines 2 and 3 are 172.5 pt wide, about 53 characters at 7.5 pt including the right-hand number and its gap. Estimated from the current artwork.

Empty slots. No serial, no card number or no parallel: that slot is blank and nothing shifts. Line 2 is never blank (see page 5).

Back positions

The hologram and the four subgrade boxes stay where they are. The line under them changes, and the QR code is new.



Cert Number. Takes the place of Card Number, which now prints on the front. Label in Arial Narrow 7 pt at 68.53, value in Brandon Grotesque Medium 7 pt at 110.

QR code. A 21.07 pt white square (0.29 in) with the quiet zone inside it. Right edge on the subgrade boxes, bottom edge level with the hologram. The code shown is a sample.

Subgrades and date. Whole numbers, centred at 110.2 and 168.7. The date spells the month: Apr 6, 2026.

Type and colour

ELEMENT	TYPE	POSITION
Subject	Brandon Grotesque Bold 9 / 9.5	Left 8.25, baseline 37.76
Version	Brandon Grotesque Medium 7.5	Left 8.25, baseline 55.71
Release	Brandon Grotesque Regular 7.5	Left 8.25, baseline 64.71
Serial, card number	Brandon Grotesque Medium 7.5	Right 180.75, same baselines
Grades	Brandon Grotesque Bold 22	Unchanged
Cert, back values	Brandon Grotesque Medium 7	Front unchanged. Back left 110
Subgrades	Brandon Grotesque Bold 10	Unchanged
Field labels	Arial Narrow 7	Unchanged, plus Cert Number:

ITEM	VALUE
Red field	C5 M100 Y100 K0
Pattern	C14 M100 Y94 K4, 0.323 pt stroke
Type and outlines	White (knockout)
Box outlines	0.5 pt, was 0.25 pt
QR code	Black on white
Tracking	0 on all type
Label	189 × 72 pt (2.625 × 1 in)

Content rules

1 **One size per slot.** Text never shrinks to fit.

2 **A dot between fields.** Fields on a line are joined by a middle dot (·). The slash is kept for serials, card numbers and multi-player names.

3 **# means card number.** Card numbers always start with #. Serials never do.

4 **Language only when not English,** straight after the manufacturer: 2023 Pokémon Japanese Pokémon Card 151.

5 **No repeats.** “Chrome Sapphire Autographs” in Chrome Sapphire Edition prints as “Autographs”.

6 **Line 2 is never blank.** Sports and non-sport print the subset or “Base”. Card games print the rarity.

7 **Short forms.** A line that runs over prints the short form saved for that card in the database. Nobody shortens text by hand.

8 **Two or more subjects** are joined by a slash in printed order. Three or more: last names only.

9 **Team does not print.**

Fifteen cards on the template

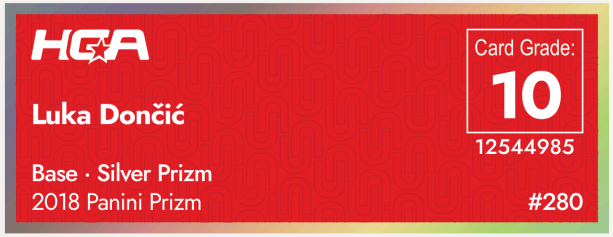
Use these to check the rebuilt file. Card details are sample data; certs, grades and serials are placeholders. Type is the stand-in.



BASEBALL · AUTOGRAPH, PARALLEL, SERIAL
The card on the current label. Every slot filled.



BASEBALL · VINTAGE BASE
No subset, parallel or serial. Line 2 prints "Base" so it is never blank.



BASKETBALL · BASE PARALLEL
Not numbered, so the serial slot stays clear.



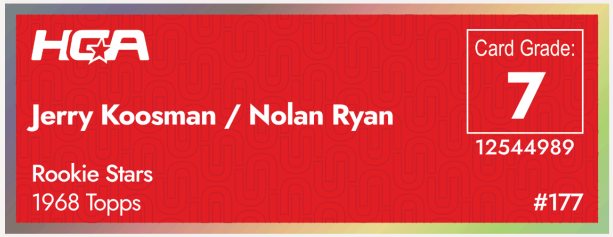
BASKETBALL · LONG NAME, SERIAL
A 23-character name holds one line beside a single grade box.



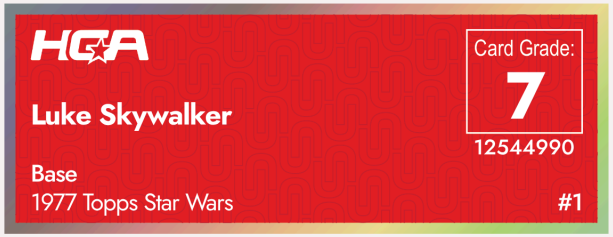
FOOTBALL · TWO GRADES, LONG VERSION
"Autograph" runs over beside the serial. The short form on file prints "Auto".



BASEBALL · PROSPECT AUTOGRAPH
The subset drops the repeated "Bowman Chrome". The longest name that fits beside two boxes.



BASEBALL · TWO PLAYERS
Names joined with a slash, in the order printed on the card.



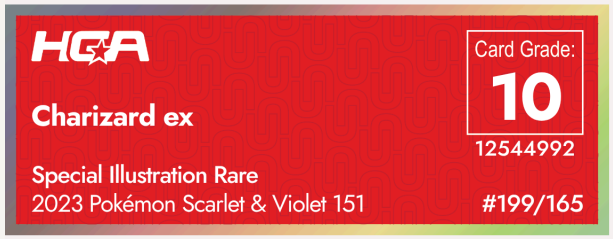
NON-SPORT
The character goes where the player goes.



POKÉMON · VINTAGE
Rarity takes the subset slot, edition takes the parallel slot. The # marks 4/102 as a card number.

Card games

Rarity takes the subset slot. Language, edition and lettered card numbers each have a fixed place.



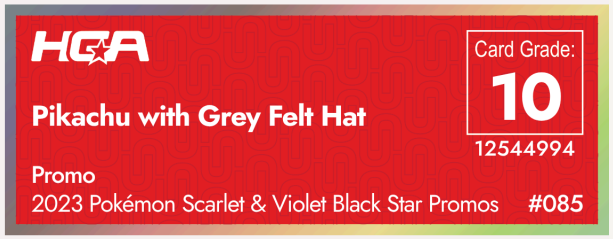
POKÉMON · MODERN

Rarity spelled out in full, not coded.



POKÉMON · JAPANESE

Language prints right after the game, only when the card is not English.



POKÉMON · PROMO, LONG NAME

About the longest Release line that still fits in full.



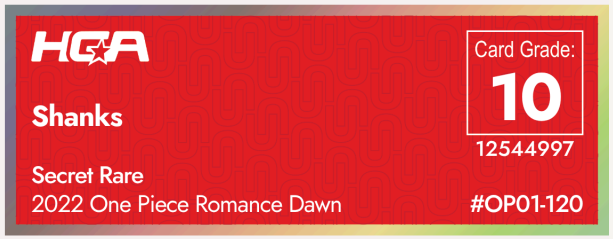
MAGIC · NO CARD NUMBER

Nothing is numbered on the card, so the slot stays blank and nothing shifts.



YU-GI-OH! · SHORT FORM

"Legend of Blue Eyes White Dragon" runs over, so the short form on file prints.



ONE PIECE · LETTERED CARD NUMBER

The number prints exactly as it appears on the card.